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Power Digital Marketing Internship Reflection

This summer, I interned at Power Digital Marketing (PDM) within their Social Department, focusing on Influencer. Power Digital Marketing is a digital marketing agency that helps brands grow by combining data-driven performance and creative strategy. They have many different departments, including influencer, paid media, SEO, organic social, and retail, among others. I started on June 2nd and continued to August 28th, working 15 hours/week (195 hours total). I received college credit for this internship and worked fully remote. I have learned so much about the company, what it is like to work in an agency environment, and the detailed work that goes into digital and influencer marketing.

In the first few weeks, it was mainly training and researching the brands that I would be working with. Each manager has around 5 or 6 clients. I mainly helped with Dazzle Dry, a non-toxic, at-home nail kit company, Bonterra Organic, a wine company, and HEYDUDE, a casual sneaker company. My first assignment was to perform a client analysis for these three brands, finding their strengths and weaknesses, identifying their audience demographic, and creating potential content ideas.

After the first few weeks, I began working on the campaigns. I would be assigned to find at least 50 influencers who would be a good fit for their campaign. I learned how to use Sprout Social, a platform that helps you find influencers with strong followings, engagement rates, and audience similarities. I also helped create creative briefs for the monthly campaign. The creative

briefs provided to influencers outline who the brand is, how to use the product, content examples, and content requirements, all while encompassing the aesthetic of the specific campaign.

Once influencers are approved, I would reach out to them over email, asking if they would like to do a paid partnership with the brand. From there, the process would include negotiating payment, contracting, concept approval, shipping product, creating content, content approval, going live, and then invoicing. I was able to work on the full influencer A-Z process for Dazzle Dry's August Campaign, which was one of the best learning experiences. At the end of the internship, I was able to create a mock-up reporting deck for Dazzle Dry, providing KPIs, what we should do differently next time, and what went well.

Additionally, I had an end-of-semester project (EOS) that I worked on with seven other interns from different departments. We were assigned to create a full marketing analysis for the brand Goodr, a sunglasses brand. I met with my team weekly and presented our project to my manager and members of the EOS project review team. This project was a great opportunity to strengthen my presentation skills while also gaining experience in other aspects of marketing analysis beyond influencer strategy.

What surprised me most was how critical some clients are when it comes to choosing the right influencer for their campaign. In influencer marketing, we look at key metrics such as engagement rate, audience similarity, audience location, etc, but there is so much more that goes into it. With a list of 50 influencers, sometimes only a quarter would be approved. This might be because the rates or price would not align, but sometimes it was also because the content was considered "too aesthetic", "too narrowly focused on...", etc. I was also surprised by the rates some influencers will charge for a paid partnership, even though their engagement rate or

following is not strong. Ultimately, I was surprised by the depth and complexity involved in influencer marketing. The classes I have taken at SCU have barely touched the surface of influencer marketing, and I think it would be super interesting to have more coverage, or even a whole class on it, since it is so relevant in today's world.

This internship has taught me many things that I will bring with me when applying to future jobs and working at different companies. First, I have learned to manage the full influencer marketing process, from outreach to invoicing. I have gained experience building strong influencer relationships, ensuring campaign deliverables align with strategy and budget, and tracking performance metrics to demonstrate ROI. I plan to highlight these achievements on LinkedIn and in job interviews by supporting them with data. For example, a 75% influencer approval rate and 100% client approval on my campaign briefs. I believe influencer marketing is a leading strategy in today's landscape, and I plan to leverage it to my advantage. Additionally, working at an agency that is fully remote has definitely taught me how important communication is. Ensuring you are constantly checking Slack, accepting Google Calendar invites a week in advance, creating an auto-email for when you are out of office, etc. These skills are essential in any business setting, but especially in a large agency where you're coordinating with many different people from across the country.

My internship did not directly correspond with the EMPAC Retail Model since it was at a digital marketing agency, but some parts could align. For matching, the client or brand must align with the influencer's audience. I applied this when curating influencer lists that reflected the brand's identity while evaluating the type of content each influencer produces and who it resonates with. For price/promotion, the pricing or promotional offers must attract the influencer

while also keeping in mind the budget. I applied this when I would negotiate rates with influencers (e.g. \$3000 for 1 TikTok, Instagram Story Series, and 1 year organic usage).

Overall, my internship at PDM was an extremely rewarding experience that gave me both practical skills and industry insights. I not only learned the full influencer marketing process from start to finish, but also gained confidence in managing campaigns, working across teams, and presenting my findings. Beyond technical skills, I developed a deeper understanding of agency work and learned how important it is to have clear communication, especially in a remote environment. I have accepted their offer to continue working with them as an intern this fall and am excited to dive even deeper into the process and continue learning about influencer marketing. These lessons will stay with me as I move forward in my career, and I feel much more prepared for my future career in marketing.